L-P-65C
September 30, 1977
SUPERSEDING
L-P-65B
May 18, 1973
MIL-P-43520
8 August 1967
MIL-P-52415B
21 March 1969

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PAILS, UTILITY, PLASTIC

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers plastic pails for carrying liquid and dry material (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Sizes. The plastic pail shall be of the following sizes as specified (see 6.2).

Size 1 - 5 pint (2 liter)
Size 2 - 5 quart (5 liter)
Size 3 - 10 quart (9 liter)
Size 4 - 12 quart (11 liter)

1.2.2 Styles Size 4 pails shall be of the following styles, as specified (see 6.2).

Style A - Galvanized steel bail
Style B - Rubber or plastic coated steel bail

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein

FSC 7240

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Federal Specifications:

L-P-390	-	Plastic, Molding and Extrusion Material, Polyethylene and Copolymers (Low, Medium, and High Density)
QQ-W-461	-	Wire, Steel, Carbon, (Round, Bare, Coated)
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Federal Standard:

FED-STD-123	-	Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies)

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA

Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-417	-	Rubber Compositions, Vulcanized General Purpose, Solid (Symbols and Tests)

(Copies of Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM)

D 968	-	Abrasion Resistance of Coatings of Paint, Varnish, Lacquer and Related Products by the Falling Sand Methods, Test for

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

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National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N. W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Standard product. The pails delivered under this specification shall be the manufacturer's commercial product, except for any changes necessary to comply with requirements specified herein.

3.2 Materials (see 6.4). Materials not definitely specified shall be of the quality normally used by the manufacturer for pails provided the completed item complies with all requirements specified herein. Unless otherwise specified herein, commercial tolerances apply.

3.2.1 Plastic. The pails shall be manufactured from polyethylene conforming to type I, class L, grade 1 or 2 or type II, class L, grade 1 or 3 of L-P-390. The plastic shall be virgin material; however, up to 5% clean unburned plastic material in the form of imperfect parts, sprues, runners or other scrap of the same composition as the virgin material and produced in the molding or finishing operation may be reground and mixed with the material specified. The color shall be at the manufacturer's option, except yellow shall not be permitted.

3.2.2 Rubber. Rubber shall meet the requirements of grade numbers RN 915 or RS 915 of MIL-STD-417.

3.2.3 Steel wire. The bail wire shall conform to one of the steel numbers 1010 through 1020, finish 5, class 1, hard temper of QQ-W-461.

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3.3 Design. Pails shall be of the capacity specified in table I. The size 1 pail shall have 1 pint ± 0.8 ounce (470 ml ± 2 ml) graduations. The size 2, 3, and 4 pails shall have 1 quart ± 1.6 ounce (945 ml ± 4 ml) graduations, (see 4.3.1). The top rim of the pails may be reinforced with wire. Size 4 pails shall have a pouring lip. At the option of the supplier, size 3 pail may have a pouring lip.

TABLE I. Capacity and body thickness

	Capacity		Body wall thickness	
	Quarts	(liters)	Inch	(mm)
Size 1	2.5	(2)	0.045	1.14
Size 2	5	(5)	0.045	1.14
Size 3	10	(9)	0.045	1.14
Size 4				
Style A	12	(11)	0.057	1.45
Style B	12	(11)	0.10	2.54

3.3.1 Size 1 pail. The pail shall be furnished with or without a bail or reinforcing rim at the manufacturer's option.

3.4 Construction.

3.4.1 Pail bodies. Pail bodies shall be made of the plastic specified in 3.2.1, except size 4, style B pails may be made of the rubber specified in 3.2.2. The thickness of the body shall be as specified in table I. The bottom side and top rim shall be an integral unit. The top rim of the pail shall be curled outward and down the side of the pail. The curl for size 1, 2, and 3 pails shall be not less than 1/8 inch (3 mm). The curl for the size 4 pails shall be not less than 1/4 inch (6 mm). Two diametrically opposite pail ears shall be molded into the rim. The pail shall taper so that when a pail of the same description is added to a stack the height of the stack will increase no more than 1-13/16 inch (46 mm) except that if the size 4 pails have a shoulder, a maximum of 3-3/2 inch (81 mm) is allowed. The difference between the bottom diameter and the height of the pails measured along the side shall not exceed 2-9/16 inch (65 mm).

3.4.2 Bails. Bails shall not become deformed or detached from the body when tested as specified in 4.3.2. The diameter of the bail wire shall be as specified in table II. Bails for size 1 pails, when furnished, and for size 2, 3, and 4, style A pails shall be made of the wire specified in 3.2.3. The bail for the size 4, style B pail shall be abrasion resistant plastic or rubber coated (see 4.2.1.1).

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TABLE II. Wire diameters and diametral deflections

Size	Minimum wire diameters Inches	(mm)	Maximum diametral deflections Inches	(mm)
1	0.117	(2.97)	---	---
2	0.121	(3.07)	1-1/2	(38)
3	0.133	(3.37)	1-7/8	(48)
4	0.136	(3.45)	2	(51)

3.5 Performance.

3.5.1 Diametral deflection. The pail shall not be deformed or broken; the bail shall not become detached and the diametral deflection listed in table II shall not be exceeded when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

3.5.2 Drop test. The pail shall show no crack or permanent set when tested as specified in 4.3.3.

3.5.3 Leakage. The pail shall show no evidence of leakage when tested as specified in 4.3.4.

3.5.4 Bleach resistance. Size 4, style B pails shall resist attack of calcium hypochlorite when tested as specified in 4.3.5.1, 4.3.5.2 and 4.3.5.3.

3.6 Marking. Each pail shall be permanently and legibly marked with the manufacturer's name, trade name, or trademark. Markings secured to the pail with adhesives shall not be used.

3.7 Workmanship. The pail shall be free of fins, sharp edges, mold marks, lumps or included foreign matter.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless other specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, in the contract, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Quality conformance inspection. Except as otherwise specified herein, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105.

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4.2.1 Component and material inspection. The supplier shall insure that all components and materials used are inspected in accordance with referenced specifications and standards unless excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.1.1 Covered bails. Plastic or rubber covered bail shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D 968. The lot shall be all bails offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-1. The sample unit shall be one bail. The lot shall be unacceptable if any bare wire is noted.

4.2.2 End item inspection. The inspection lot shall be all pails of the same description offered for inspection at one time. The sample unit shall be one pail.

4.2.2.1 Visual examination. Examination shall be made of the end item for the defects in table II. The inspection level shall be level II with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 2.5 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. Visual examination

Defects	Classification Major	Minor
Sizes or styles not as specified.	X	
Yellow color.	X	
Fins or sharp edges.	X	
Measurement marking illegible.	X	
Bail does not have clearance.		X
Marking is missing, illegible, not permanent, i.e., such as applied with adhesive.		X
Pouring lip missing, when required.		X

4.2.2.2 Dimensional examination. The pails shall be examined for compliance with dimensions specified. Any dimension not within the specification tolerance shall be a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 6.5, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.2.2.3 Testing of the end item. The pail shall be tested as specified in 4.3.1, 4.3.2, 4.3.3 and 4.3.4. Size 4, style 1 pails shall be tested as specified in 4.3.5. The inspection lot shall be all pails of one description offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2. The sample unit shall be one pail. Any failure shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

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4.2.2.4 Packaging inspection. An examination shall be made to determine that the preservation-packaging, packing and marking comply with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table III. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed in table III shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE III. Examination of packaging

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged. Any nonconforming component.
Workmanship	Inadequate applications of components such as: incomplete closure of container flap, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Distortion of container.
Weight	Weight of container exceeds the specified limitation.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 Graduation and capacity test. The graduated pail shall be filled to each graduation with measured amounts of water specified in 3.3. Inaccurate graduations constitute failure of this test. When the pail is filled to the top graduation or to within 1/4 inch (6 mm) of the top, as applicable, failure to contain the capacity specified in table I shall constitute failure of this test.

4.3.2 Diametral deflection test. The outside diameter of the pails which extends through the centers of the bail attachment holes of the body shall be measured. The pails shall be filled with water to the brimful capacity. The water temperature shall be 130° ± 5°F (55° ± 2°C). The pails shall be emptied after 5 minutes and refilled as specified above. After 2 minutes, the pail shall be lifted and the shorter deflected outside diametral dimension shall be measured while the pails are suspended. Diametral deflections in excess of those specified in table II, evidence of leakage or detachment of the bail shall constitute failure of this test.

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4.3.3 Drop test. The pail shall be filled to brimful capacity with crushed ice. After 15 minutes of time have elapsed, the pail shall be raised to a height of 3 feet (1 m) above a concrete floor and tilted at an angle of 45 ± 2 degrees. The pails shall be released and allowed to fall freely, with the bottom pail edge striking the concrete. Any crack, permanent set or dislodgement of the bail constitutes failure of this test.

4.3.4 Leakage. The pail shall be filled to the top graduation with water and allowed to stand for not less than 1 hour. Evidence of leakage constitutes failure of this test.

4.3.5 Bleach resistance. Three samples of size 4, style B pails shall be filled to the rated capacity with a 5 percent by weight calcium hypochlorite solution. The pails shall be placed in a circulatory oven and maintained at temperature of 160° ± 5°F (71.1° ± 2°C) for 168 hours ± 2 hours. The level of solution shall be maintained each day. After conditioning, the bleach solution shall be removed. One pail shall be tested as specified in 4.3.5.1, one pail shall be tested as specified in 4.3.5.2 and one pail shall be tested as specified in 4.3.5.3.

4.3.5.1 Strength. A 40 pound (18 kg) weight shall be placed in the pail and the pail shall be raised by the bail at the rate of 2 feet (600 mm) per second for 2 seconds. Deformation of the pail or detachment of the bail shall constitute failure of this test.

4.3.5.2 Temperature test. The pail shall be conditioned at 20° ± 2°F (-6.7° ± 1°C) for 1 hour. The pail shall be removed from the cold chamber, immediately raised to a height of 6 feet (1.8 m) and dropped onto a concrete floor. The drop shall be repeated six times. Evidence of chipping or cracking shall constitute failure of this test.

4.3.5.3 Storage test. The pail shall be conditioned at a temperature of -25° ± 2°F (-31.7° ± 1°C) for 4 hours and then conditioned at a temperature of 125° ± 2°F (52.6° ± 1°C). Evidence of damage shall constitute failure of this test.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Six pails of like description only shall be nested and packaged upright within a snug-fitting fiberboard box conforming to style RSC, variety SW, class domestic, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. Each box shall be closed in accordance with PPP-B-636.

5.1.2 Commercial. The pails shall be packaged in accordance with normal commercial practice. The complete package shall be designed to protect the item against damage during shipment, handling and storage.

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5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Pails of like description only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed upright in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.2.2.4. Weight of content of each shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds (29.5 kg).

5.2.2 Level B packing. Pails of like description only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed upright in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF (variety SW) or type SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.2.2.4. Weight of content of each shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds (29.5 kg).

5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant shipping containers. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.2.2.4.

5.2.3 Commercial. The pails shall be packed in fiberboard boxes to insure safe delivery at destination, to provide for safe redistribution by the initial receiving activity, and shall be acceptable by common carrier under National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be as specified in 5.3.1 or 5.3.2 (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123.

5.3.2 Military requirements. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Plastic pails covered by this specification are intended to be used for carrying water, paint, and other liquids or dry materials, except size 4, style B pails should not be used to carry or store concentrated acids or strong oxidizing agents.

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6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the perferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Size and style required (see 1.2 and 1.2.2).
(c) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
(e) Marking required (see 5.3).

6.3 Classification comparison. L-P-65B dated May 18 1973, MIL-P-43520 dated 8 August 1967 and MIL-P-52415B dated 21 March 1969 have been consolidated as follows:

L-P-65C	L-P-65B	MIL-P-43520	MIL-P-52415B
Size 1	Size 1	---	---
Size 2	Size 2	---	---
Size 3	Size 3	---	---
Size 4, style A	Size 4	Type I, class 1	---
Size 4, style B	---	Type III	Size 2, grade B

Type I, class 2 and type II of MIL-P-43520 and size 1 and grade A of MIL-P-52415 were deleted since these options were not referenced to procurable items of supply.

6.4 Recycled material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirement of this specification (see 3.2).

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - YD
Air Force - 99

Review activities:

Army - MD, AT
Navy - MS
DLA - DH

User activity.

Navy - CG

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Civil Agency Coordinating Activity:

GSA-FSS

Project No. 7240-0203

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